



PROGRESS REPORT

AI: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-31

Edition of 2026-08-31 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

3 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

AFRICA · SOUTHERN AFRICA · WEST AFRICA

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-31	MOVEMENT
Africa AI Council	Did not exist	Established under a board of 42 heads of state with the AU Commissioner for Energy and Infrastructure and the ITU Secretary-General; no work programme or output held in the nine months since	ADVANCED
Free student access to a commercial assistant	Did not exist	A technology company offered African students one year of its paid artificial-intelligence assistant tier at no charge, pitched at study materials, assignments and planning	ADVANCED
Fund departmental paper on artificial intelligence in the region	Did not exist	A departmental paper on the potential of artificial intelligence across sub-Saharan Africa, held in full as published	ADVANCED
Pan-African AI governance research and advocacy project	Did not exist	A four-year research and advocacy project on pan-African AI governance, funded at EUR 1,873,314 and running 2026 to 2030, implemented by a consortium of a German university media research centre and three civil-society organisations; the position it argues from is common principles through continental institutions rather than 54 national AI regimes, covering data governance, AI ethics, procurement standards, regulatory sandboxes, cross-border research and capacity-building	ADVANCED
Africa AI Fund	Announced in April 2025 at US\$60bn, alongside the Africa AI Declaration, with nothing capitalised	Still cited as one pillar of the continental AI architecture; no capitalisation, governance structure or disbursement held	NO CHANGE
AU Continental AI Strategy	Adopted 2024-07-19 as the continental reference for national AI policy, on an implementation timeframe running 2025 to 2030	Unchanged in text, and the reference the Commission carried into global forums; ministers meeting at the ECA called for its translation into national frameworks. The instrument's own timetable runs Phase I across 2025-2026, a midterm review in 2027 and Phase II from 2028	NO CHANGE

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-31	MOVEMENT
Monitoring and evaluation of the AU Continental AI Strategy	Provided for in the Strategy through an African AI readiness index, a public monitoring dashboard and regional AI observatories, with nothing published	Still nothing published; the Peace and Security Council requested the Commission and its AI Advisory Group to submit periodic reports on 2026-04-16, and the Strategy's own midterm review falls in 2027	NO CHANGE
Common African Position on AI and its Impact on Peace, Security, Democracy and Development	BASELINE NOT HELD	The Council requested the Commission to expedite the comprehensive study and the Common African Position and submit them for its consideration; a Policy Brief on AI for Peace, Security and Governance in Africa is reported in progress and no text is published	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Google Africa Applied AI Lab	Did not exist	A co-development programme based at the Accra AI Community Centre and run with the sponsor's AI futures fund, giving selected African startups from pre-seed to Series C+ pre-release access to its Gemini, Gemma and Veo models plus research mentorship and go-to-market support, with no equity taken and no cash award guaranteed; it closes with a demo day in Accra	BASELINE NOT HELD
Public capital committed to the AU Continental AI Strategy	Baseline not held	About US\$150m of public capital committed by African governments against an implementation cost the Strategy itself prices at between US\$250bn and US\$500bn - a fraction of one per cent - and an ambition to add US\$1.5 trillion to Africa's GDP by 2030; independent research over the Strategy's first eighteen months found the funding heavily concentrated in Kenya, Nigeria, South Africa and Egypt, with little reaching the remaining member states	BASELINE NOT HELD

Southern Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-28	MOVEMENT
COMESA regional AI strategy	Did not exist	Stakeholder consultation held under the World Bank-supported IDEA programme to inform the strategy and its action plan; no draft, drafter or adoption route published	ADVANCED
SADC Regional Artificial Intelligence Strategy and Regulatory Framework	BASELINE NOT HELD	Under development according to Malawi's ICT ministry (2026-06); no draft, adoption date or Secretariat document held; a regional workshop at Harare on data governance in the artificial-intelligence age, convened with the World Bank, a continental alliance and a United Nations agency, set out to harmonise member states' data policy for readiness	<i>Baseline not held</i>

West Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-30	MOVEMENT
ECOWAS Regional AI Governance Framework	Did not exist	Resolved to be developed, citing algorithmic bias, labour displacement and information disorder; no draft, drafting body or date held in the six months since; a four-country comparative study presented on 2026-08-10 found none of Benin, Senegal, Cote d'Ivoire or Burkina Faso holds AI-specific legislation in force or in draft, rating Cote d'Ivoire's strategy the most advanced of the four on inclusion and data governance and finding Burkina Faso's data-protection law the only one to name AI-based processing	ADVANCED, MARGINAL

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-30	MOVEMENT
Francophone West African AI governance guidelines	Did not exist	Adopted by Benin, Burkina Faso, Cote d'Ivoire, Guinea, Mali and Senegal; advisory, complementing national strategies rather than replacing them	ADVANCED

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.